

Strengthening Disability-Inclusive Sexual and Reproductive Health Services in Kilifi County

Building on County Leadership to Institutionalize Inclusive SRHR Services



Executive Summary

Kilifi County has emerged as one of the leading counties in promoting the rights of persons with disabilities through the enactment of the Kilifi County Persons with Disabilities Act, 2022. The Act establishes a legal framework for protecting the rights of persons with disabilities by prohibiting discrimination, improving accessibility to public services and information, strengthening participation in county governance, and establishing the Kilifi County Board for Persons with Disabilities to oversee implementation.

Although the Act is not specific to sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), it creates a strong legal foundation for disability-inclusive SRHR by guaranteeing equal access to healthcare services, accessible information and communication, and protection of the dignity and rights of persons with disabilities.

Despite this progress, many persons with disabilities continue to face barriers when accessing SRHR services, including inaccessible health facilities, limited disability-inclusive health information, inadequate communication support and inconsistent provider capacity to deliver inclusive care.

The priority for Kilifi County is therefore to integrate disability inclusion across all SRHR programmes, developing implementation guidelines, strengthening provider capacity, improving accessibility and establishing sustainable financing and accountability mechanisms.

Why This Matters

Persons with disabilities have the same sexual and reproductive health needs and rights as everyone else. They require access to:

- Family planning information and services
- Maternal and newborn healthcare
- Adolescent sexual and reproductive health services
- HIV prevention, testing and treatment
- Cervical and breast cancer screening
- Prevention and response to gender-based violence
- Sexual and reproductive health information in accessible formats

However, barriers in accessing these services continue to increase the risk of unintended pregnancy, poor maternal outcomes, unplanned reproductive health conditions, gender-based violence and exclusion from healthcare. Building disability-inclusive SRHR services will improve health outcomes, promote equity and help ensure that no one is left behind

Key Implementation Gaps

Despite the county’s commitment to disability inclusion, important gaps remain.

Priority Area	Priority Action
Disability-inclusive SRHR services	Strengthen and scale up disability-inclusive SRHR services across all county health facilities
Guidelines and implementation	Develop and disseminate disability-inclusive SRHR guidelines for all service providers
Physical barriers	Remove physical and communication barriers to access reproductive health services
Information and communication	Make SRHR information available in accessible formats such as Braille, Easy Read, audio or Kenyan Sign Language
Provider training	Build capacity of healthcare workers and strengthen disability-inclusive SRHR service delivery
Monitoring and accountability	Integrate disability-specific indicators into county SRHR monitoring systems
Budget allocation	Allocate a dedicated budget for disability-inclusive SRHR services

Priority Advocacy Actions for Kilifi County

Priority Area	Lead Institution	Recommended Advocacy Action	Expected SRHR Outcome
Develop County Guidelines for Disability-Inclusive SRHR Services	County Department of Health, County Health Management Team (CHMT), Department of Social Services	Develop county implementation guidelines and standard operating procedures for disability-inclusive SRHR services aligned with the Persons with Disabilities Act, 2022, and existing county legislation.	Standardized disability-inclusive SRHR services across all county health facilities.
Improve Accessibility of SRHR Services	Department of Health, Department of Public Works, Kilifi County Committee	Upgrade maternity units, family planning clinics, HIV service delivery points, and health facilities to meet universal accessibility standards (ramps, wide consulting rooms) and disability-friendly waiting areas.	Persons with disabilities can access SRHR services with ease, dignity and without stigma or barriers.
Build Capacity of Healthcare Providers	Department of Health, Professional Training Institutions, CHMT	Integrate disability-inclusive SRHR into Continuous Professional Development (CPD). Train healthcare providers on disability rights, clinical decision-making, communication and sensitivity ethics of care.	Improved quality of care and reduced stigma and discrimination within health facilities.
Strengthen Disability-Inclusive Planning and Budgeting	County Treasury, County Assembly, Department of Health	Establish dedicated budget allocation for disability-inclusive SRHR information, provider training, assistive communication services, accessible IEC materials and community outreach programmes.	Sustainable financing for disability-inclusive SRHR services.
Strengthen Community Participation	Department of Social Services, Department of Health, Organizations of Persons with Disabilities (OPDs)	Ensure persons with disabilities and OPDs participate in county planning, budgeting, monitoring and evaluation of SRHR programmes.	County SRHR programmes respond to the priorities and lived experience of persons-with disabilities.
Strengthen Monitoring and Accountability	CHMT, Health Information Unit, Monitoring and Evaluation Unit	Integrate disability indicators into county SRHR reporting systems and routinely collect data disaggregated by age, sex, disability, status and type of disability.	Improved evidence for tracking, monitoring, equitable access and strengthening accountability.

County Implementation Scorecard

Implementation Area	Current Status	Priority Action
Disability-inclusive SRHR implementation guidelines	● Not Available	Develop county implementation guidelines and service standards.
Accessible SRHR infrastructure	● Moderate	Upgrade all county health facilities to meet accessibility standards.
Accessible SRHR information	● Low	Produce SRHR information in accessible formats across all facilities.
Healthcare worker capacity	● Moderate	Institutionalize disability-inclusive SRHR training through CPD programmes.
Community participation	● Moderate	Strengthen engagement of OPDs in county planning, budgeting and monitoring.
Disability-responsive budgeting	● Moderate	Create dedicated budget allocation for disability-inclusive SRHR interventions.
Monitoring and reporting	● Low	Integrate disability-disaggregated SRHR indicators into county health information systems.

Kilifi County has already demonstrated leadership in promoting the rights of persons with disabilities. The next step is to ensure that these commitments are reflected in every health facility, every SRHR programme and every county budget.